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Lecture Notes

Village Unity - Solidarity Of What Type?

→ Shah and Srinivas are first generation of Sociology in India.

↓
→ trained in Oxford

→ founding members of Delhi University

→ The early sociologist critiques about the wrong ideas of the colonial system.

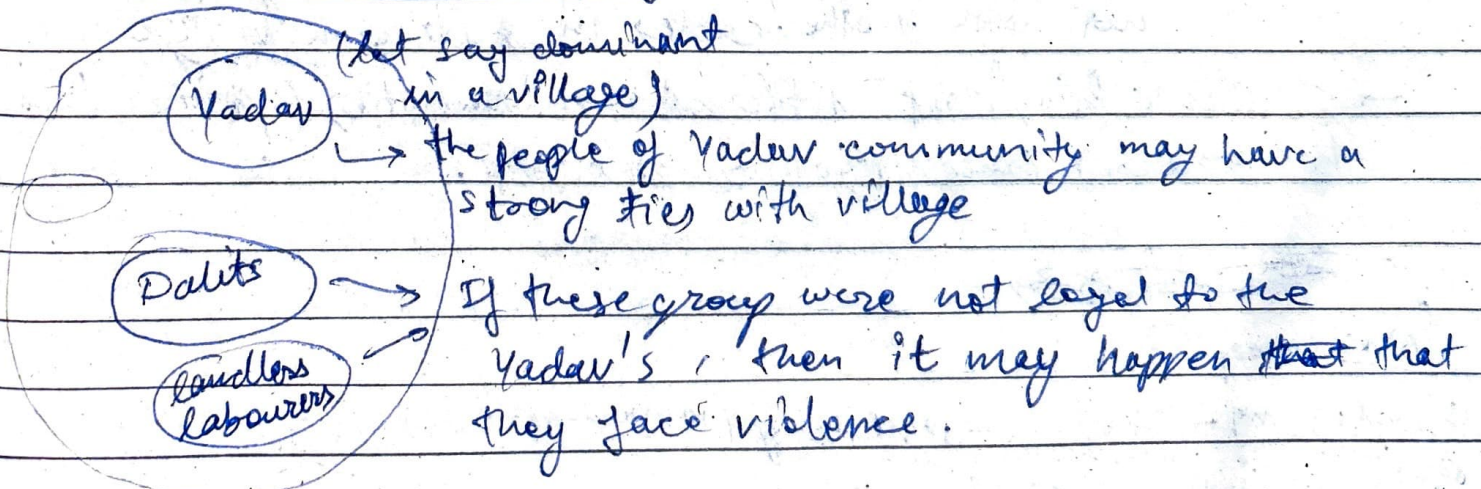
→ Re-addressed the idea of village Republic.

→ Loyalty to entire village or to dominant caste only?

→ people are not loyal to village, they are loyal to the dominant caste.

(dominant caste need not to be Varna, it can on the basis of political, number of people, etc).

→ Coercive or voluntary?



* What is the nature of the links between members of the same village?

↳ Just because it is a village it may not be that people behave a sense of unity.

Objective

boundaries
gate

Architectural

↓
Physical structure of village:

Subjective

often this is different from
objective idea of village

Sociological

may be there are many village, in a village

M N Srinivas (we have to go beyond the objective)

↳ "Myth" of self sufficiency

→ Economic

→ political

→ Network and Inter-dependence

→ sociological unity

→ Villages were always involved in network of relations with different villages.

Daughter $\xrightarrow{\text{Marriage}}$ Exchange (Kanyadan)
 Gifts $\nearrow$

→ After marriage, there is constant movement of people from one to other village.

→ These interrelationship affects the economic of a village.

→ these points were accounted by the britishers, foreign writers in their texts.

Village As Site of Nostalgia

Village v/s city

- After 1947, still more people lived in villages.
- Bombay, Kolkata, Madras and Delhi → These ~~are~~ were the main city, and Delhi was the capital city.
- ↳ For trades and finance.

- In the beginning it was learning of Village Sociology.

Romance and Nostalgia of Village life

- Also industrialisation, modernisation started at that time, like dams were made, good infrastructure developed. There was view that heart resides in village and cities are materialistic. (Idea of Swaraj, governance → Village)

Nation in the village

Village / rural as site of nostalgia (1950s cinema)

- Nehru → thinks that villages needs to be modernise.
- MK Gandhi → it is feel of nostalgia or belongingness.
- Ambedkar → seeks to escape out of villages.

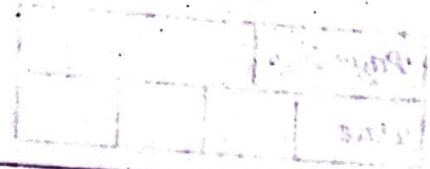
→ Where is the "real" India?

→ Village in economic critique of colonialism.

→ Rural v/s Urban? Does this opposition remain viable today?

→ OR Rural-Urban continuum?

→ Rurban?



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What (where is a village?)

→ Today what we are thinking about the villages, is totally different from the ideas in the past.

- Population?
- Economy?
- Size?